

Creating Custom Themes in Drupal 8

A theme in a website is a set of files that defines the overall look and the user experience of a website. It usually comprises all the graphical elements such as colours and window decorations that help the user to customise the website. Drupal provides the user with a bunch of basic themes for a website that are very generic. However, these default themes do not suit all types of users. So there is a need to build themes that meet one's requirements.

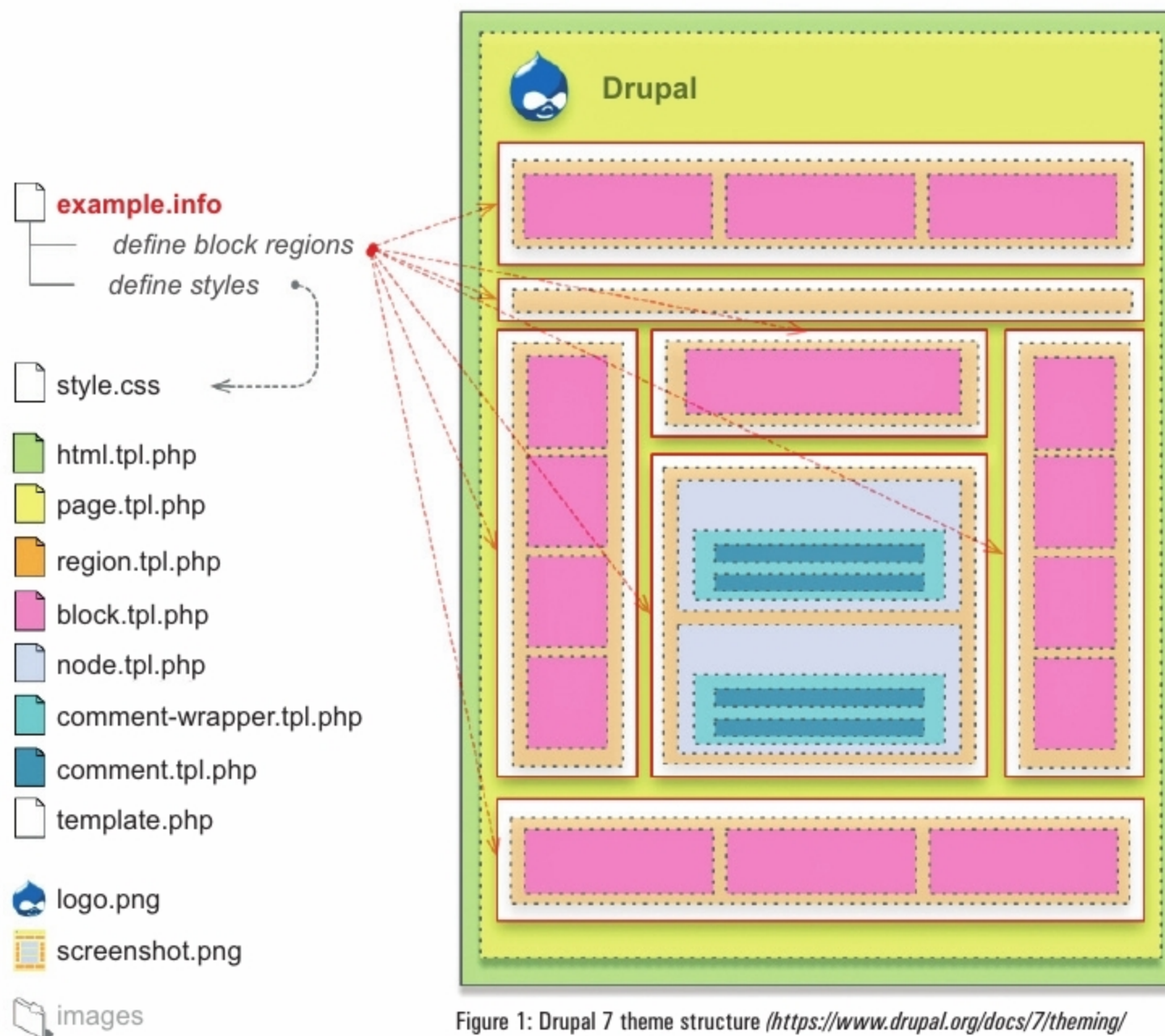


Figure 1: Drupal 7 theme structure (<https://www.drupal.org/docs/7/theming/overview-of-theme-files>)

Creating and customising themes in Drupal 8 is easy because of a modern template engine for PHP named Twig, which is a part of the Symfony 2 framework. Moving from a PHP template to Twig, and from the INI format to YAML, are some of the main changes in Drupal 8 theming. These changes in Drupal 8 have improved the security and inheritance, making theming more distinguished.

With reference to Figure 1,

- **.info** provides information about your theme.
- **html.tpl.php** displays the basic HTML structure of a single Drupal page.
- **page.tpl.php** is the main template that defines the contents on most of the pages.
- **style.css** is the CSS file that sets the CSS rules for the template.
- **node.tpl.php** defines the contents of the nodes.
- **block.tpl.php** defines the contents in the blocks.
- **comment.tpl.php** defines the contents in the comments.
- **Template.php** is used to hold preprocessors for generating variables before they are merged with the markup inside **.tpl.php** files.
- **Theme-settings.php** is used to modify the entire theme settings form.